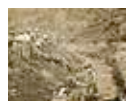




Ford GT's IQ

The new Ford GT takes a stunning 10 million lines of code to run and process over 100 GB of data every hour. <http://dgit.in/FordCode>



North Korean graves

South Korea's TJWG tracks locations of mass graves on North Korea with the help of defectors and Google Earth. <http://dgit.in/NKgrave>



Cheap cards are coming

Ethereum miners are soon going to discard their GPUs. Should you buy these cards?

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Every single cryptocurrency boom has been short-lived for the PC. That's because when it hits mainstream popularity and a lot of GPU toting PC enthusiasts start mining these alt-coins, the difficulty ramps up rapidly and that has happened with every single cryptocurrency so far. Ethereum has already peaked and crashed a couple of times since May when it first became ultra popular. And now, we're at a stage where the mining difficulty is so high that folks with two GPUs cannot mine these coins profitably. In a couple of weeks, those with three or four cards will not find it profitable. Two more weeks down the line and miners with six or seven cards will not find it profitable. You see where this is going, right? All these miners are going to sell off their existing GPUs before the resale value on these cards drops drastically. That means, a lot of RX 480 / 470 / 460 and GTX 1070 / 1060 are going to hit the market at dirt cheap rates. So the question is - Should you buy a used GPU that has been working at peak load, 24x7, for the last couple of months?

Before we get into the economics, let's explore what happens to a GPU when it is run at peak load 24x7. For starters, graphics cards running at peak load will heat up a lot, we're talking in the 80-95 degrees celsius range for the entirety of its mining period. Just lower than the thermal thresholds so that the driver and the GPU itself does not initiate throttling. This affects components like the capacitors which, if electrolytic, start getting bloated.

varies across models as build quality varies with each manufacturer and with each series that the manufacturer has. So it's quite likely that you will luck out and get a pretty decent graphics card for cheap that'll last you for two years.

Trust me, getting any of the graphics cards mentioned above for cheap and having them last for two years is more than enough and you'll certainly have got your money's

worth. Speaking of money, how much should you pay for such a graphics card? The seller is definitely going to try to ask for full price since you can't find these cards in the market owing to low stocks.

However, you should not, under any circumstance, pay full price for a used card. The maximum you

should consider is 60% of the original price prior to the cryptocurrency induced inflation. So if you're looking at an RX 480 which used to retail for ₹18-19K for the 4 GB variant then you should pay around ₹11K only. Do note that these cards should be treated as only having half their life left. Also, you should ask to test the card out for a couple of days before completing the deal. Use this period to run a couple of games at maxed out settings and look for video artifacts, coil whining and random BSODs. It's always



Inductor chokes will slowly start whining at lower workloads. The fans, depending upon the bearing design, will lose some of their stability and excessive heat is known to affect the winding as well. So if the second hand graphics card you're looking forward to buying has been running at peak load for 3-4 months, then you're looking at something that is unlikely to survive two years, if you are lucky. Again, this